a FlexLifeFi K–12 program

GRADE 6 · PARENT GUIDE

What to Watch For at Home

One good question per quarter — no quizzing, no pressure.

Year theme: Businesses Need Systems and Roles

CONTENTS

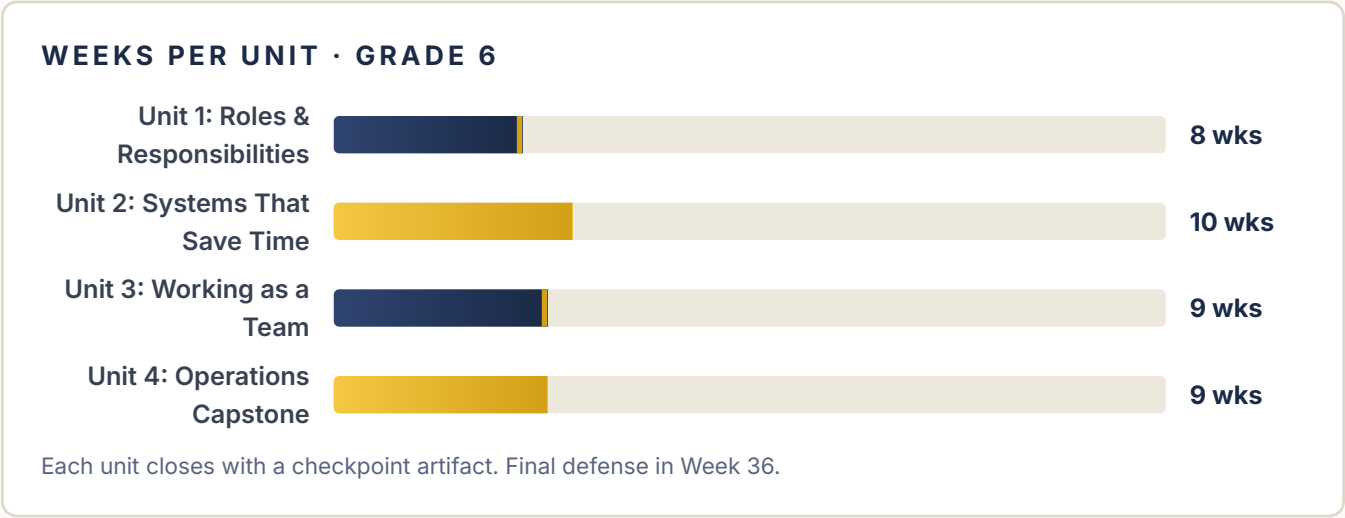
What's Inside

01 What this year is
02 What your student is bringing home
03 What you don't need to do
04 What you can do (if you want)
05 Things to watch for
06 Privacy and sensitivity
07 A note about success this year
08 Questions?
09 Senior expert upgrade pack — Three-question script for team conflict
10 ROUND 2 PATCH — Three 30-Second Conversation Starters per Quarter (Grade 6)
11 ROUND 2 PATCH — What Cash Never Says (Parent Reference)

YEAR-AT-A-GLANCE

Four Units. Thirty-Six Weeks. One Capstone.

The year is built as four units, each ending with a public-facing artifact that feeds the rolling Capstone. The bars show how the weeks are spent — roughly equal, with a slight lean toward the math-heavy unit because per-customer math is the load-bearing skill.



36 WEEKS

4 UNITS

10 LESSONS

8 CASH VIDEOS

GRADE 6 · PARENT GUIDE

What to Watch For at Home

Most adults run their lives without a system. You won't.

A short, practical guide for the adult who lives with a Grade 6 Cash to Company student.

What this year is

"Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true."

— CASH

This year, your student is learning how a business actually runs — not the logo, not the pitch, but the systems and roles underneath. The big move of the year is **businesses need systems and roles**. Across four units, your student maps real value chains, writes their first Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), builds a one-month ledger with a savings-rate goal, fills out a RACI chart with a 4-person team, draws their own line on legal-but-sketchy ethics cases, and runs a two-week stand-up with one documented adjustment.

By June, your student delivers a 3–4 minute Capstone Defense covering all four pieces of their hypothetical venture. Most students don't start a real business this year. The point isn't the business; the point is the muscles: writing the boring step, sharing the work, making the ratio talk to the dollars.

What your student is bringing home

You'll see:

- A **Capstone Journal** — the messy notebook where they sketch, plan, and reflect.
- A **Student Activity Book** — structured worksheets with value chains, SOPs, ledgers, RACI charts, ethics sorts, and stand-up logs.
- Occasional **Cash videos** to watch (2–3 minutes each) — short animated explainers from the program's mascot, Cash.
- **Vocabulary terms** they're starting to use: value chain, segment, SOP, ledger, savings rate, RACI, root cause, stand-up.

If those terms feel new, that's fine — you don't need to know them. Your student will explain.

What you don't need to do

"A little less wrong, every week."

— CASH

- **You don't need to know any of this.** A parent with no business background can fully support this curriculum.
- **You don't need to fund anything.** Capstones run on paper. If your student wants to launch a real venture, that's a family decision and outside the curriculum's expectations.
- **You don't need to share your finances.** Curriculum-wide policy: no student is asked to share family financial details. The ledger work uses a hypothetical 12-year-old's small business — the math is real, the numbers are made up. If your student asks a money question that feels invasive, redirect them — there's no homework that requires it.

What you can do (if you want)

These are optional. None are required.

1. Ask one good question a quarter

- **September–October (Unit 1):** "Pick a business in town. What's the chain — who's the supplier, the producer, the seller?"
- **November–January (Unit 2):** "What's an SOP at your school? What's a step that has a check?"
- **February–April (Unit 3):** "Tell me about a 'legal but sketchy' thing you've noticed. Where would you draw the line?"
- **May–June (Unit 4):** "In a stand-up: what did you do yesterday, what's today, what's stuck? What's stuck for you?"

You don't need to know the right answer. You're modeling curiosity, not expertise.

2. Tell them about an SOP you actually follow

If you've ever followed a checklist at work — for a procedure, a setup, a launch, a recipe — your story is gold. If you can show your student that real adults at real jobs use real checklists, you've reinforced the year's most important lesson. Household examples (bedtime routines, the way you lock up at night) work too.

3. Be a "stranger" for the SOP pair test

If your student writes an SOP and asks you to try to "do" it, take it seriously. Try to follow the steps without asking questions. Where you pause, ask, or guess, that's information. Tell them what was unclear. (Adults love to "help" by filling in the gaps. The point is to not fill in gaps so the SOP gets better.)

4. Notice systems with them

When you encounter a real-world system — a queue at the airport, a coffee shop's fulfillment, the library's checkout — point it out. Ask what would happen if a step were skipped. The world is full of SOPs and RACIs in disguise; once you see them, you can't unsee them.

Things to watch for

> *"You don't have to know everything. You have to know one number."*
>
> — CASH

A "great idea" that needs you to spend money

Two responses both work:

- **"What did your math say it would cost? What's your savings rate?"** (Pulls them into the work.)
- **"This sounds like a real-life version, not a class version. We can talk about whether to do that."** (Separates the curriculum from the family decision.)

A RACI that resurfaces a group-project grudge

If your student vents about teammates, validate briefly, then steer toward the system: "What if there had been a clear A on every task? Would that have helped?"

Something that doesn't sit right ethically

If your student's venture leans toward exclusion, manipulation, or anything else that pings you, mention it to the teacher. The curriculum has built-in pivot windows three times a year for exactly this.

Stand-up "stuck" that sounds real

If your student says they're "stuck" on something at school or home, the stand-up muscle is working. Listen. The point of naming a Stuck is so somebody can help unblock it. You're a great unblocker.

Real money requests

If your student asks for real money for the Capstone, this is a family conversation, not a curriculum requirement. The Capstone can be done entirely on paper.

Privacy and sensitivity

The curriculum uses fictional 12-year-olds for ledger scenarios, fictional names for RACI examples, and stays in the middle-school lane for ethics. No homework asks how much your family spends on anything. If something feels off, contact the teacher. The teacher can adjust assignments, swap ventures, or modify pacing for any reason — including a flag from a caregiver.

A note about success this year

"Which people, and how do you know?"

— CASH

A successful Grade 6 student does not necessarily start a business, make money, or impress a panel. A successful student:

- Mapped a real local business's value chain with specifics at each node.
- Wrote a 5-step SOP with checks that a stranger could actually follow.
- Built a one-month ledger and computed a savings rate.
- Filled out a RACI with exactly one Accountable per task.
- Ran a two-week stand-up and documented one adjustment.

If you see those five things on the kitchen table over the year, the program worked.

Questions?

Your student's teacher is the first stop. They can also send home longer-form materials (the Curriculum Book, the Lesson Plans) if you'd like a deeper look.

Thank you for being part of this. The biggest predictor of whether a financial-thinking habit sticks is whether it's also alive at home — even at the level of one curious question per quarter.

— The Cash to Company team

Senior expert upgrade pack — Three-question script for team conflict

If your Grade 6 child comes home and says "we had a fight in our team meeting today," here's a script that honors both the curriculum and your kid:

You: "Tell me what happened — just the facts, not who was right."

Child: (tells the story)

You: "Was the fight about who was supposed to do something, or about what was supposed to be done?"

Child: (thinks; usually it's about who)

You: "What does your RACI say? Who's accountable for that task?"

Child: (may say "we don't have one" or "Maya is")

You: "What would you change about the RACI in your next meeting?"

End. You've done the entire Grade 6 leadership lesson in three questions. You don't have to take sides. You don't have to fix it. You ask the questions; the child does the thinking.

Other one-question prompts

- "What's the SOP your team uses for [task]?" (Surfaces whether one exists.)
- "What's your savings rate target this month?" (At Grade 6, this is a real conversation — they have a percentage in mind.)
- "Did your team have a stand-up this week? What did each person say?" (Practices Did → Doing → Stuck.)
- "What's the legal-but-sketchy decision your team had to make?" (Surfaces ethics if any came up.)

ROUND 2 PATCH — Three 30-Second Conversation Starters per Quarter (Grade 6)

Quarter 1 (Value Chain + 5 Whys) 1. In a grocery store: "Where did this apple start? Wheres the supplier? Whos the seller? Whos the customer?" — Follow-up: "Whats the chain?" 2. Drive-time: "Whats something annoying that happened today? Why did it happen? Why? Why again?" — Follow-up: "Did we hit the root cause?" 3. At dinner: "Whats one business in our town with a complex value chain?" — Sample: "The bakery — wheat farm, miller, baker, customer."

Quarter 2 (Ledger + Savings Rate) 1. Drive-time: "If a kid earned $200 this month and spent $150, whats their savings rate?" — Sample: "25%." — Follow-up: "Is that high or low?" 2. In the kitchen: "If we kept a one-month ledger of our food costs, what would we learn?" — Follow-up: "Whats one thing wed try to lower?" 3. At dinner: "Whats a hypothetical 12-year-olds biggest expense in a small business? Lemons? Sugar? Travel?" — Follow-up: "How would they reduce it?"

Quarter 3 (SOP + RACI + The "Team Fight" Script)

If your child says "we had a fight in the team meeting today":

- **You:** "Whats the fight about?"
- **Child:** "Tomas keeps changing the recipe."
- **You:** "Whos Responsible for the recipe?"
- **Child:** "Maya, but Tomas keeps changing it."
- **You:** "Sounds like RACI confusion. Whos Accountable — the person whose name is on the line if its wrong?"
- **Child:** "...we never decided."
- **You:** "Thats the fix. Decide. Want me to listen while you talk to Maya about it?"

Quarter 4 (Legal-but-Sketchy + Weekly Stand-up) 1. Watching a commercial: "Is that ad fully fine, legal-but-sketchy, or over the line?" — Follow-up: "Why?" 2. On Sundays: "Lets do a weekly stand-up. What did you do, what are you doing, what are you stuck on?" — Sample: "Did the science fair, doing the persona pack, stuck on customer interviews." — Follow-up: "Whats one move on the stuck thing?" 3. At dinner: "Whats one thing your business did this week that you wouldnt do again?" — Follow-up: "Whats the SOP fix?"

Sensitivity: None of these require the family to share home finances. They work for any family.

ROUND 2 PATCH — What Cash Never Says (Parent Reference)

Cash will never say: "Amazing!" / "Everyone can be rich" / "Easy money" / "Passive income" / "Just believe in yourself" (as substitute for evidence) / anything implying money problems are a personal failing.

Cash always asks: "Which people, and how do you know?" / "Whats the evidence?"

Why this matters at home. Your child will encounter financial-literacy content from many sources, some hustle-bro coded. The contrast is the point. Cash is on your familys side: clear-eyed, honest, never selling.

One question this year: "Did Cash ask you a question this week? What was it?"

ABOUT THE HOST

Cash, in five words

curious · warm · honest · patient · specific

"I'm Cash. I don't promise wealth. I don't promise success. I promise that the moves — interview, math, message, listen — will make you a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."

— CASH

What Cash does

- **Asks questions that point to evidence.** Cash never tells; Cash asks what your evidence says.
- **Names rules sparingly.** "An assumption is something you think is true without checking. Evidence is something you observed, heard, or counted."
- **Tells short, made-up-but-realistic stories.** 30–60 seconds, shows don't tell.
- **Celebrates the move, not the win.** Revision, honesty, and evidence — not revenue.
- **Hedges deliberately.** probably, often, sometimes — never absolutes about complex topics.

What Cash never does

- Flatter ("amazing!", "great job!"), promise wealth, moralize about money.
- Reference real brands or living celebrities as endorsements.
- Surface family financial details. (Hypothetical scenarios only.)
- Pretend the world is fair. Cash is honest about systemic factors without becoming a politics class.

> *When in doubt, work one of these into the script: Which people, and how do you know? · Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal. · Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. · A little less wrong, every week.*

STRAND OUTCOMES

Eight Strands. One Year. Verifiable Outcomes.

Cash to Company runs the same eight strands K-12. Each year deepens the demonstration. The Grade 6 version of each strand is below.

Code	Strand	Grade 6 demonstrated outcome
BAVC	Business Awareness and Value Creation	Identify a business problem, propose a value-creation hypothesis, and revise it with customer evidence.
PSIG	Problem Solving and Idea Generation	Generate, screen, and refine ideas; document why one was chosen and the others were not.
MFL	Money and Financial Literacy	Compute revenue, variable cost, contribution margin, and breakeven for a real product or service.
CBM	Customers, Branding, Marketing	Build a persona from interview evidence; design honest messaging; A/B test two claims.
OSO	Operations, Systems, Organization	Design a simple weekly operating cadence with named roles, handoffs, and a feedback loop.
LTO	Leadership, Teamwork, Ownership	Run and document a team meeting; resolve one disagreement using shared evidence.
ESL	Ethics, Safety, Legal Awareness	Identify the line between persuasion and manipulation; flag one borderline claim and rewrite it honestly.
LRCI	Launch Readiness and Continuous Improvement	Pilot, measure, and document at least three iterations with rationale and what changed.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

Six Benchmarks This Year

Standards are cited at the benchmark level. Honest gaps are named when they exist. The Capstone artifact addresses each one.

Benchmark	What students must demonstrate
Jump$tart 2 (Spending & Saving) 8-1	Identify ways to deposit, store, and pay for goods and services.
CCSS-ELA SL.6.1	Engage effectively in collaborative discussions; build on others' ideas.
CASEL Self-Management	Set and monitor goals; manage time.
C3 D2.Eco.4.6-8	Describe the role of competition in the determination of prices and wages.
CASEL Relationship Skills	Establish and maintain healthy relationships; communicate effectively.
Jump$tart 6 (Financial Decision Making) 8-2	Identify ways that consumers may avoid making poor decisions.

HOW TO READ THIS TABLE

Each lesson cites at least one of these benchmarks. Each Capstone checkpoint addresses two or more. The Teacher Guide includes a per-lesson standards crosswalk.

"Standards aren't a cage. They're a list of moves you're going to be glad you can make. Pick one. Practice it. Move on."

— CASH

CAPSTONE RUBRIC (4-POINT)

How We Score the Capstone

The Capstone artifact is scored on four traits, each on a 4-point scale. Honest, specific, decision-oriented work earns the high marks. Generic or assumption-laden work earns the low ones.

Trait	1 — Emerging	2 — Developing	3 — Proficient	4 — Advanced
Evidence quality	Mostly assumptions; few or no quotes.	2-3 interview quotes; partial evidence.	5+ direct quotes; varied sources; coded patterns.	Triangulated quotes plus behavioral observation; counter-evidence acknowledged.
Per-customer math	Confused costs; no contribution margin.	CM computed but with errors; one price scenario.	Correct CM and breakeven; clear pricing rationale.	CM under multiple price scenarios; LTV-lite reasoning.
Honest messaging	Vague or misleading claims.	Some specifics; some unsupported claims.	All claims supported; clean ethics check.	A/B-tested copy with rationale; resists clever-but-borderline phrasing.
Feedback system	One-time check; no documentation.	Ad-hoc feedback; partial revisions.	1-week feedback loop with 3 documented changes.	Sustained loop plus signal-vs-noise analysis plus revision log.

CALIBRATION NOTE

Score honestly. A "3" means the student met the standard the way an adult professional would. A "4" means they did something a working entrepreneur would be proud to show. Withhold "4" unless the work earns it.

SENSITIVITY AND FAMILY ENGAGEMENT

What We Don't Ask. What We Always Frame.

Money is a tool, not a virtue. Some students live in households with credit-card debt, low or no banking access, or active financial stress. The curriculum is built so that none of those students is asked to disclose, perform, or apologize for their family situation.

Rules of the room

- **Never ask about family money.** No questions about parents income, debts, accounts, or banking status.
- **Use neutral hypotheticals.** "For a sample family with a $4,000/month take-home" — not "your family."
- **Decouple wealth from worth.** Cash never says "everyone can be rich." Cash says "you will be a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."
- **Name systemic factors honestly.** Wage gaps, geography, and luck shape outcomes. The skill we build is the skill in the student hands.
- **Protect the venture.** A student Capstone is theirs. We don't require they share revenue or family contribution. The artifact is the work, not the bank account.

Family engagement

Parents get one well-framed question per quarter — never a quiz, never a money-disclosure prompt. The default frame is curiosity ("What did you notice about your customers this week?"), not interrogation ("How much did you make?").

"Money is a tool. The question is not whether your family has a lot of it. The question is what you do with the moves we are practicing — interview, math, message, listen — wherever your starting line happens to be."

— CASH

ACTIVITY INDEX

Ten Activities. One Notebook.

Every activity in this book is built to be done with a pencil, your own evidence, and the questions Cash keeps asking. Skip nothing. Date everything. Re-read in three months.

No.	Activity	What you will do
01	Day 1 Customer Assumption	One sentence, one card. Don't try to be right; try to be specific.
02	Open vs. Leading Questions	Rewrite five leading questions into open ones. Practice on a partner.
03	Coding Patterns from Transcripts	Highlight surprises, frustrations, wishes. Tally them. Find the pattern.
04	Persona Pack v1	Combine evidence into one specific person — name, behaviors, top frustration.
05	Variable Cost per Unit	From a real receipt, compute the cost per one of the thing you sell.
06	Contribution Margin Worksheet	Price minus variable cost. Decide if it covers your fixed costs.
07	Two-Message A/B Test	Two honest messages. Three-day test. Report the winner and why.
08	Persuasion vs. Manipulation Line	Sort 10 ad claims onto a line. Defend your placement.
09	1-Week Feedback Loop	Collect, code, and act on feedback. Document three changes.
10	Final Capstone Defense	Five slides. Five minutes. Show the moves you made.

NOTEBOOK SETUP

Get a single notebook for the whole year. Number every page. The first 5 pages are your Vocabulary Spine. The last 5 pages are your Day-1 Assumptions (you will come back to those). Everything in between is your work.

Notebook checklist

- **Title page** — your name, your venture working-title, today's date.
- **Vocabulary spine** — 5 pages reserved for definitions you will add as we go.
-

Customer notes — one section for interview transcripts. Use direct quotes, with initials and dates.

- **Math section** — receipts taped in, per-unit computations, contribution margin scratch work.
- **Messaging section** — drafts of two-claim A/B tests, with what won and why.
- **Feedback log** — one page per week of your feedback system, with the three changes you made.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Worked Example: Roles That Save Time

Maya runs a small backyard car-wash on Saturdays with three friends. Last weekend, every kid did every job. They washed nine cars in five hours. They argued twice. Two cars came out streaky. Maya's notebook says: "Same kid greeted, soaped, rinsed, and took the money. Bottleneck: the towel-dry. Decision: split into roles."

This week, Maya assigns roles. Greeter, soaper, rinser, dryer, money. They wash twelve cars in five hours. Zero arguments. No streaks. Same humans. Different system.

WHAT TO COPY

The move here is not the answer. It is the structure: specific number, specific person, specific decision. Use that pattern in your own venture this quarter.

> *"Most adults skip this. You won't. Pick one customer. Compute one number. Decide one thing." — Cash*

END-OF-QUARTER REFLECTION

Four Quarters. Same Five Questions.

At the end of every quarter you will answer the same five questions. The answers should look different over time. Reread the previous quarter before you write a new one.

1. **Which people did you talk to this quarter, and what did they actually say?**

   Specific quotes, initials, dates. Resist the urge to summarize.
2. **What did you change in your venture because of evidence?**

   Name the change. Name the evidence that caused it.
3. **What is one number you know better now than three months ago?**

   Variable cost per unit. Contribution margin. Anything quantitative.
4. **What is a claim you made that you would take back?**

   Be honest. The claim does not have to be public. The honesty is the move.
5. **What would Cash ask you about all of this?**

   "Which people, and how do you know?" is always available. Find your own version.

> *"Reflection is not a feeling check-in. It is a memory tool. The you in three months wants to know what the you today learned. Write it down so future-you can use it."*
>
> — CASH

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move through this program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepreneurship — no matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We promise clarity.

"Most adults run their lives without a system. You won't."

— CASH, GRADE 6